

Global Hunger, Child Malnutrition, and Solutions to End Hunger

Introduction

Hunger is one of the biggest humanitarian challenges in the world. Millions of people do not have enough food to live healthy lives. Every day, children die because they do not receive enough nutritious food. Hunger affects health, education, economic growth, and the future of entire countries. Around 645 million people experienced hunger worldwide in 2025.

Global Hunger Statistics

- Around 645 million people experience hunger worldwide.
- Nearly 2.3 billion people experience moderate or severe food insecurity.
- Millions cannot afford a healthy diet.
- Africa and parts of Asia remain the most affected regions.

Suggested graph values: 2022 - 688 million, 2023 - 688 million, 2024 - 673 million, 2025 - 645 million.

Child Malnutrition

Malnutrition is the lack of proper nutrition needed for healthy growth. Major forms include stunting, wasting, underweight, and micronutrient deficiencies.

- 148 million stunted children.
- 45 million wasted children.
- 37 million overweight children under five.

Child Deaths

Around 4.9 million children under five died in 2024 from different causes, with malnutrition contributing to many of these deaths.

- Per year: 4.9 million.
- Per day: about 13,400.
- Per hour: about 560.
- Per minute: about 9.

Causes and Effects

Major causes include poverty, war and conflict, climate change, natural disasters, food waste, high food prices, lack of education, poor healthcare, unemployment, and political instability.

Hunger weakens immunity, slows growth, affects brain development, reduces school attendance, lowers concentration, and damages the future productivity of communities and countries.

Countries Most Affected

Somalia, Sudan, South Sudan, Ethiopia, Yemen, Afghanistan, and the Democratic Republic of Congo are among the places most deeply affected.

Food Waste and Solutions

Large amounts of edible food are wasted every year by households, restaurants, supermarkets, and during transportation. Reducing waste could help feed millions.

- Improve agriculture and support poor farmers.
- Reduce food waste.
- Expand school meal programs.
- Improve healthcare and nutrition education.
- Strengthen food banks and international cooperation.

One Person Can Make a Difference

If every person who has enough food helped feed one hungry person whenever possible, through donations, food banks, or reducing food waste, we could significantly reduce hunger and lower deaths related to malnutrition. Although this alone cannot eliminate hunger because poverty, conflict, healthcare, and food distribution also play major roles, collective action from millions of people can save lives.

Conclusion

Hunger remains one of the world's greatest challenges. Governments, organizations, and individuals all have a role to play. By reducing food waste, supporting food assistance programs, and helping those in need, we can move closer to a world where no child sleeps hungry and everyone has access to nutritious food.

References: World Health Organization, UNICEF, FAO, and World Bank Joint Child Malnutrition Estimates.